

Directory

Alexander Glazunov

1865–1936, RUSSIAN

Born in St. Petersburg, Glazunov began composing at the age of 11 and received private lessons from Rimsky-Korsakov. The success of his First Symphony, premiered when he was 16, won him precocious entry into the circle of composers patronized by Russian music publisher Mitrofan Belyayev. By the 1890s, he had formed his mature style, blending Romanticism with Classicism and Russian with Western influences. A stream of symphonies, concertos, ballets, and chamber works secured Glazunov's place as a composer of international standing. In 1905, he was appointed as the director of the St. Petersburg Conservatory. Under pressure of teaching and administrative duties, his output declined. He remained at the head of the Conservatory after the 1917 Bolshevik Revolution, numbering Shostakovich among his pupils, but in 1928 moved to the West. Dismissive of musical Modernism, he was